

Information Technology, Digital Media, and Digital Communications Committee

Lacamas Watershed Council

July, 2026

1. Executive Summary

Purpose. The purpose of this document is to establish the operational framework for the LWC Information Technology, Digital Media, and Digital Communications Committee ¹. This document will also establish the budget for the committee and describe chair and volunteer responsibilities.

IT, digital communications, and marketing have all been named under this committee as a matter of efficiency. Though communications and marketing could be a separate committee, the majority of digital marketing tools will be provisioned by the IT officer and come from the IT budget. Therefore, treating LWC marketing, branding, and communications under the IT umbrella reduces bureaucracy and opens a direct line of communication between the IT officer and LWC digital marketing volunteers.

Goals. The goal of the Committee is to support the LWC's vision ² by providing efficient technological support, unified branding, and consistent, honest communication to the community and our partners. We will utilize technology and a modern digital presence to restore, protect, and advocate for our watershed. We will never recommend a technology or media strategy that contradicts the LWC's mission and vision, and we will never advocate for technology or media strategies that directly harm our local, regional, or global ecosystems.

Overview. The Committee Chair must be a Board member (ideally the Secretary and Information Officer). All other members can be LWC volunteers on or off the Board. The Committee has two branches: information technology and digital media and communications. The information technology branch is responsible for managing our Google Workspace, databases, and other digital resources. The digital media and communications branch is responsible for creating LWC branding, managing our content calendar, taking and editing photos, and sending newsletters. On an annual basis, the Committee will evaluate current technology and branding trends and propose adding or removing certain technologies to the Board for approval. Also on an annual basis, the IT branch will conduct an audit of our Google Workspace in order to better organize and de-clutter the Google Drive.

Budget. The total proposed annual budget is \$1,114, with \$288 allocated to the IT branch and \$826 allocated to the digital media and communications branch. The Committee is funded from the LWC's unrestricted funds. Recurring monthly donations from two

¹Hereafter referred to as "the Committee"

²Establishing a safe, healthy and enjoyable watershed with a robust lake management plan safeguarding the future.

Board members contribute \$1,080 annually to the unrestricted funds, offsetting most of the Committee's cost. These donations are unrestricted gifts to the LWC and are not designated for the Committee. The Committee's budget is appropriated by the Board and is neither contingent on these donations continuing nor an obligation on the donors to continue them.

2. Approval

After deliberation the Board will appoint a Committee Chair and vote to approve this document along with any amendments. Approving this document funds the Committee through December 31, 2027. This includes a prorated budget of \$464 for August through December 2026 and the full annual budget of \$1,114 for the 2027 calendar year.

3. Committee Structure

3.1. Information Technology Branch

The information technology branch is responsible for managing the LWC's Google Workspace, databases, and other digital resources. The IT branch purchases, sets up, and maintains all LWC digital tools so that the organization can succeed in a modern digital environment.

Budget. The proposed budget is \$288, which is the minimum needed to meet our website and domain name needs. The Committee recommends adding a password manager for two individuals (President and Committee Chair) at a cost of \$96 annually. This \$96 is not included in the \$288 requested here; approving this document does not authorize it, and the Committee must obtain separate Board approval before incurring that cost. All other IT services are either free or covered under our AWS nonprofit credits.

Tools and cost.

- Google Workspace: Free at our current usage
- Amazon Web Services (database, data dashboard): \$1,000 in nonprofit credits.
- Domain name: \$11.64
- Squarespace (website): \$276
- Password manager (proposed, not funded by this budget): \$96

3.2. Digital Media and Communications Branch

The digital media and communications branch is responsible for creating LWC branding, managing the content calendar, taking and editing photos, and sending newsletters. The digital media branch also covers printed media including stickers, fliers, t-shirts, door hangers, and posters. However, it is the recommendation of the Committee to use printed media sparingly. This is a cost saving measure and also reinforces our stance as an environmentally sustainable nonprofit.

Budget. The proposed budget is \$826. The DM branch needs a total of \$156 annually to cover Mailchimp. In addition, we propose an additional \$150 for social media advertising, \$420 for Adobe Creative Cloud Pro to support photo editing and graphic design, and \$100 for printed media (primarily up-front t-shirt costs that will be recouped).

Tools and cost.

- Mailchimp: \$156
- Social media advertising (proposed): \$150
- Adobe Creative Cloud Pro (proposed): \$420
- Printed media (proposed): \$100 (primarily for up front t-shirt costs that will be recouped)

4. Roles and Responsibilities

4.1. Committee Chair

The Committee Chair must be a Board member and, ideally, is the LWC Secretary and Information Officer. The Chair is responsible for maintaining the Committee's budget, organizing volunteers, and ensuring that the Committee's goals are met. The Chair will also serve as the primary point of contact between the Committee and the Board. However, most importantly, the Chair should have domain knowledge of information technology and information security, given that the Committee is responsible for managing the LWC's private digital resources. Other duties of the Chair include, but are not limited to:

- Orchestrating regular communications with IT and digital media volunteers with the latest Board decisions.
- Managing the LWC's Google Workspace, including user accounts, permissions, and security settings.

- Managing the LWC's water quality database and establishing data sharing policies with other organizations.
- Ensuring consistent uptime of the LWC's website.
- Finding and implementing the correct IT tools to support the LWC's mission and vision.
- Finding and implementing the correct digital media tools to ensure consistent branding and messaging across all LWC digital platforms.

4.2. Other IT & Digital Media Volunteers

All digital media volunteers are responsible for creating content for the LWC's digital platforms, including social media, newsletters, and the website. When appropriate, they will also create printed media. Some common volunteer positions that fall under this category include:

Communications & Outreach Volunteer. Responsible for creating the LWC's content calendar, brand guide, and social media strategy. This volunteer will also be responsible for creating and sending newsletters, and managing the LWC's newsletter contacts database. The C&O volunteer is the Board's voice to the public and will provide guidance to the Board on how to best communicate LWC operations to the widest possible audience.

Photographer & Videographer Volunteer. Responsible for taking and editing photos and videos for the LWC's digital communications and social media. This volunteer should understand how to use the basic functions of a digital camera and have a basic understanding of photo and video editing software.

Social Media Volunteer. Responsible for creating and posting content to the LWC's social media platforms and adhering to the content calendar. This volunteer should have a basic understanding of social media platforms and how to drive social engagement.

Website Volunteer. Responsible for maintaining the LWC's website and ensuring that it is up to date with the latest LWC information. This volunteer should have a basic understanding of web development and content management systems (like Squarespace or WordPress).

5. Amendments and Adding Projects

5.1. Amending this Document

Major Amendments. A major amendment is a significant change to the document that affects its overall structure or purpose. This includes changing goals, adding new projects, and adding or modifying defined roles. To make a major amendment, a Board member must submit a proposed amendment for review by the Board. The proposed amendment must be approved according to the LWC's bylaws (including quorum requirements per Article 3.6). Once approved, the proposed amendment will be added to this document within thirty (30) days by the Committee Chair, and the document will be re-published and distributed to the relevant stakeholders. The Committee Chair is responsible for maintaining this document and ensuring that it is up to date with the latest amendments.

Minor Amendments. A minor amendment is a small change to the document that does not significantly affect its overall structure or purpose. This includes correcting typos and other small changes. The Committee Chair makes the initial determination of whether an amendment is major or minor. To make a minor amendment, the Committee Chair will initiate the amendment(s) and notify all Board members of the changes at a Board meeting or by email to the full Board. The amendment will be incorporated into this document within thirty (30) days of notification. At any point, a Board member can request that a minor amendment be reviewed as a major amendment, at which point the amendment will be held pending the outcome of that review.

A. Motions for Board Approval

The following motions are provided for the Board's convenience in acting on this document. Motions A.1 and A.2 are taken in the order given, so that a Chair is appointed before the Committee's charter is approved, as required by the LWC Charter. Motion A.3 is optional and is presented separately because the \$96 password manager is not included in the budget requested in section 2.

A.1. Motion to Appoint the Committee Chair

I move that the Board appoint [*name*], currently serving as [*office*], as Chair of the Information Technology, Digital Media, and Digital Communications Committee, to serve until the next annual meeting of the Board.

A.2. Motion to Approve this Document and its Budget

I move that the Board approve the document titled *Information Technology, Digital Media, and Digital Communications Committee*, dated July 2026, as the charter of that Committee, and that the Board appropriate from unrestricted funds a prorated budget of \$464 for August 1 through December 31, 2026, and a full annual budget of \$1,114 for the 2027 calendar year, funding the Committee through December 31, 2027.

This appropriation comprises \$288 to the information technology branch and \$826 to the digital media and communications branch. It does not include the proposed \$96 annual password manager, which requires separate Board approval before the Committee may incur that cost.

A.3. Motion to Authorize a Password Manager

This motion is required only if the Board elects to fund the password manager described in section 3.1. If it is not adopted, the Committee's budget stands as approved under motion A.2.

I move that the Board authorize an additional \$96 annually for a password manager for the President and Committee Chair, increasing the Committee's annual budget to \$1,210 and the prorated 2026 budget to \$504.